The Nuclear Command Authority comprises a Political Council and an Executive Council. The Political Council is chaired by the Prime Minister. It is the sole body which can authorise the use of nuclear weapons.

The Executive Council is chaired by the National Security Advisor. It provides inputs for decision making by the Nuclear Command Authority and executes the directives given to it by the Political Council.

CONNECT CENTRAL ASIA POLICY OF INDIA

India launched the "Connect Central Asia" Policy in 2012. This policy is aimed at strengthening and expanding of India's relations with the Central Asian countries. These countries include Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan and Uzbekistan.

India's "Connect Central Asia" policy is a broad-based approach including political, security, economic and cultural connections. Its features (or elements) are as follows[5]:

1. India will continue to build on its strong political relations through the exchange of high level visits.

2. India will strengthen its strategic and security cooperation. The focus will be on military training, joint research and counter-terrorism coordination.

3. India will step up multilateral engagement with Central Asian partners using the synergy of joint efforts through existing fora like the SCO, Eurasian Economic Community (EEC) and the Custom Union.

4. India looks to Central Asia as a long-term partner in energy, and natural resources.

5. The medical field is another area that offers huge potential for cooperation.

6. India's higher education system delivers at a fraction of the fees charged by Western universities. Keeping this in mind, India would like to assist in the setting up of a Central Asian University in Bishkek.

7. India is working on setting up a Central Asian e-network with its hub in India, to deliver, tele-education and tele-medicine connectivity, linking all the five Central Asian States.

8. Indian companies can showcase India's capability in the construction sector and build world class structures at competitive rates.

9. As for land connectivity, India has reactivated the International North-South Transport Corridor (INSTC).

10. Absence of a viable banking infrastructure in the region is a major barrier to trade and investment. Indian banks can expand their presence if they see a favourable policy environment.

11. India and Central Asian nations will jointly work to improve air connectivity between them.

12. Connections between the people are the most vital linkages to sustain the deep engagement. India and Central Asian nations will encourage regular exchanges of scholars, academics, civil society and youth delegations to gain deeper insights into each other's cultures.